RG DEVS



RG HotelOS Setup Guide

How to install, set up and hand over RG HotelOS at a hotel, from the office PC to the first night audit.

Version 1.0.7 · November 2026

rgdev.ke@gmail.com · WhatsApp +254 140 205 383
kenrodgersutugi-tech.github.io/rg-hotelos-releases

Contents

1. What you need
2. Prepare the router and the office PC
3. Install RG HotelOS
4. The setup wizard and your licence
5. Backups: do this on day one
6. Printers, menu, staff and devices
7. M-Pesa for guest payments
8. Everyday running
9. If the server breaks or is stolen
10. Hand-over checklist
11. Support and licence plans

How RG HotelOS works. One office PC (the *server*) holds the hotel's data and runs the system. Reception, waiters, the kitchen, the cashier and managers use tablets, phones or PCs on the hotel Wi-Fi, in their web browser. Nothing needs the internet except M-Pesa prompts, Google Drive backups, licence renewals and updates, so the hotel keeps working when the internet is down.

1 What you need

Item	Notes
Server PC	Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit), 8 GB RAM, SSD. Wired to the router with a cable, not Wi-Fi.
UPS	For the server PC **and** the router. The data survives a power cut, but a UPS keeps tablets working through short outages.
Router and Wi-Fi	Wi-Fi that covers every floor where staff work.
Thermal printers	80 mm ESC/POS printers for the kitchen, bar and receipts. Network printers are best: note each one's IP address from its self-test page.
USB stick	16 GB or more. It becomes the backup drive and is kept away from the server.
Internet for setup	Needed only for the licence step. A phone hotspot is fine.
Tablets or phones	Any recent Android tablet or phone, or a Windows PC, with Chrome or Edge.

2 Prepare the router and the office PC

1. **Give the server a fixed IP address.** In the router, reserve an address for the server PC (often called "DHCP reservation" or "static lease"). Do the same for each network printer.
2. **Use a private network**, such as 192.168.x.x or 10.x.x.x. For safety, RG HotelOS refuses to serve a public address.
3. **Set the Windows network to Private:** Settings → Network → your connection → Private.
4. **Power after a cut:** in the PC's BIOS, set "Restore on AC power loss" (also called "After Power Loss") to **On**, so the server switches itself back on. On an HP Pro 3500: press F10 at start-up → Advanced → Power-On Options → After Power Loss → On.
5. For extra safety, turn on BitLocker (Windows Pro) so a stolen PC can't be read.

3 Install RG HotelOS

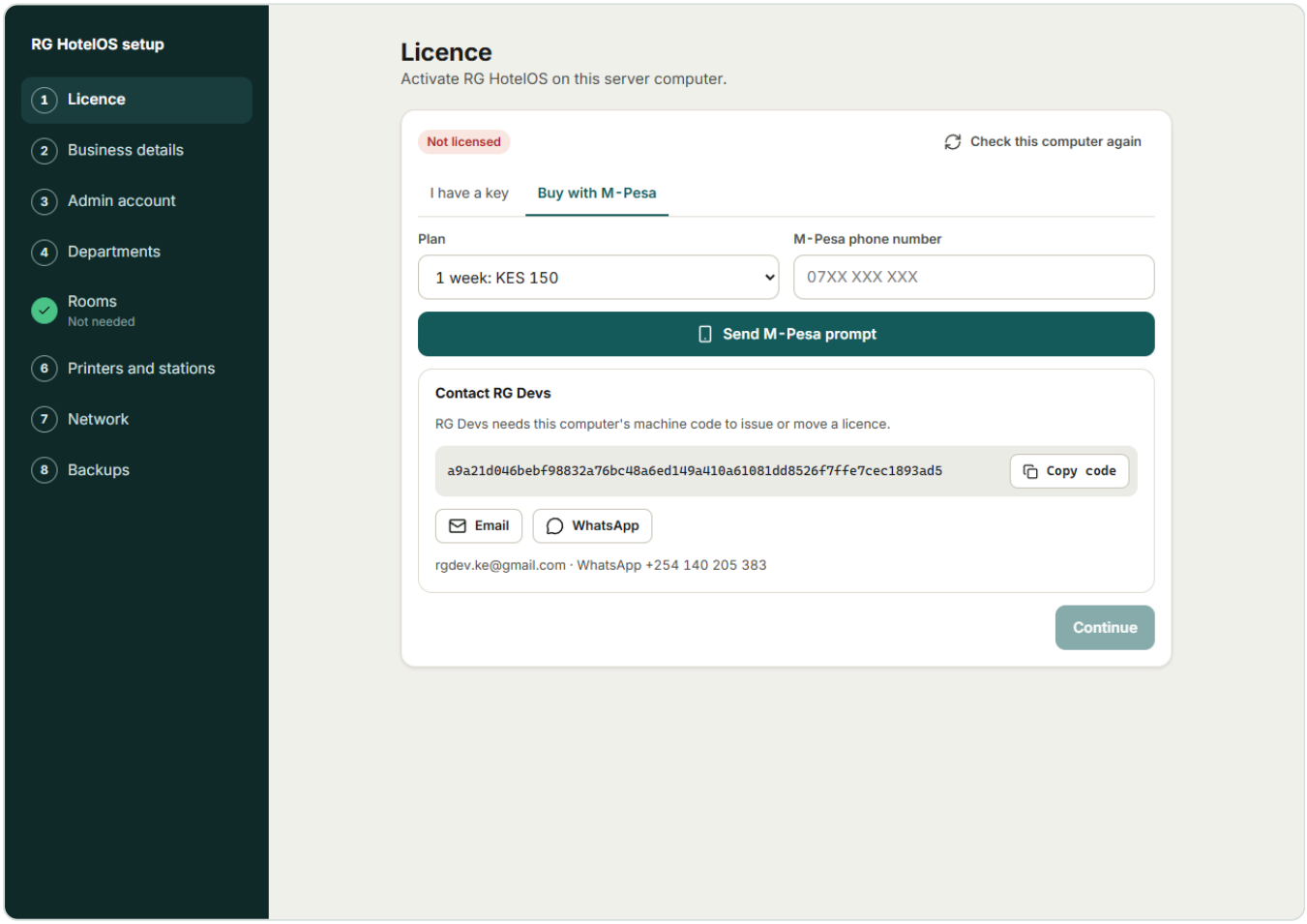
1. Download `RG-HotelOS-Setup-1.0.7.exe` from the RG HotelOS website (Download section) or from RG Devs.
2. Right-click the installer → **Run as administrator**.
3. If Windows SmartScreen says "unknown publisher", click **More info** → **Run anyway**. This shows until RG Devs' code-signing certificate is in place.
4. The installer sets up:
    - the **RG HotelOS Server** Windows service, which starts with Windows and restarts itself if it stops;
    - firewall rules that open RG HotelOS to the hotel network only;
    - a power plan that never lets the PC sleep;
    - Windows Update active hours of 06:00 to 23:00, so Windows doesn't restart during service.
5. When it finishes, the RG HotelOS window opens the setup wizard on the server PC.

> Install RG HotelOS on the server PC only. Tablets and phones need no installation: they connect in their web browser (see section 6).

4 The setup wizard and your licence

The wizard takes about 15 minutes and goes through these steps:

1. **Licence.** Choose one:
   - **Start a free trial:** 14 days with every feature.
   - **I have a key:** type the key RG Devs gave you.
   - **Buy with M-Pesa:** choose a plan, enter the M-Pesa number and approve the prompt on the phone. The licence turns on by itself, even if the screen is closed or the PC restarts after paying. Renewals work the same way: nobody has to send a key.
2. **Business details:** hotel name, phone and logo. They appear on every screen and printout.
3. **Admin account:** the owner's or manager's username and a 6-digit PIN. **Print or write down the admin recovery key** it shows, and give it to the owner.
4. **Departments:** tick what the hotel has, such as rooms, restaurant, kitchen, bar, store and housekeeping.
5. **Rooms:** room types, nightly rates and room numbers. Ranges like `101-110` work.
6. **Printers** and **Network** (shows the address tablets use), then **Backups**. You can also do these later.



The licence step. "Contact RG Devs" sends the hotel name and machine code to RG Devs by email or WhatsApp.

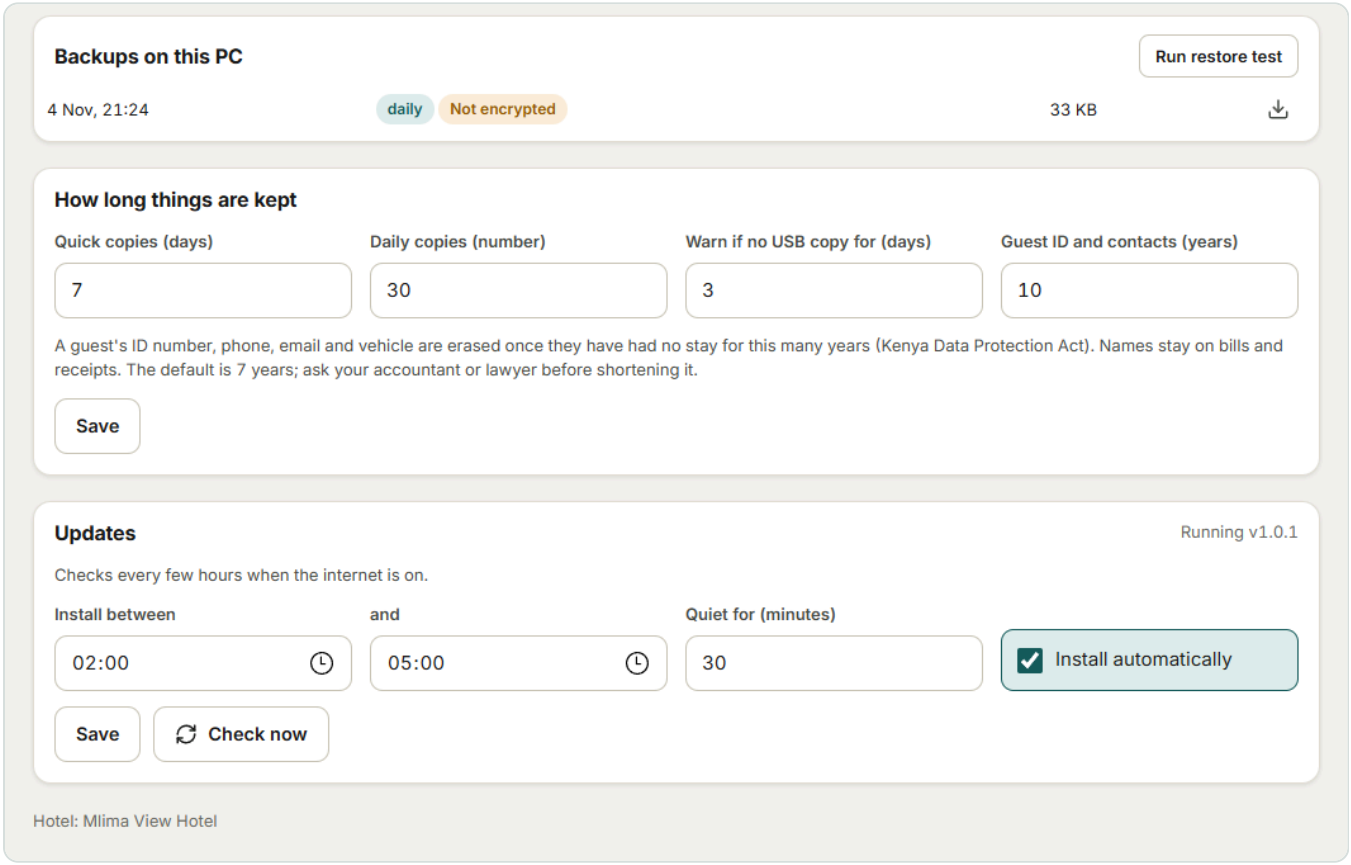
Replacing a broken server? On the very first screen choose **Restore a backup instead** (see section 9).

5 Backups: do this on day one

RG HotelOS makes a copy of the data every 15 minutes on the server. Copies leave the server only after the recovery key exists, because every copy that leaves is encrypted with it.

1. Open **Backups and updates → Make the recovery key**.
2. **Print the Backup Recovery Sheet** and give it to the owner, who keeps it away from the hotel. Type the key back in to confirm.
3. Plug in the USB stick → **Use for backups**. From then on, the latest daily copy goes onto it automatically whenever it's plugged in.
4. Optional: **Connect Google Drive**. The owner signs in on their phone, and a daily copy goes to the hotel's own Google Drive.
5. Under **How long things are kept**, check how long guests' ID numbers are kept (7 years by default, under the Kenya Data Protection Act).

> **Without the recovery key, backups cannot be opened, by the hotel or by RG Devs.** Keep the sheet safe, and never keep it next to the server.



Backups and updates: copies on the PC, how long things are kept, and automatic updates.

6 Printers, menu, staff and devices

Printers

Printers → Add printer: enter the network printer's IP address (or choose a USB printer) and press **Test print**. Then set the **stations**: which printer prints kitchen tickets, which prints bar tickets, and which prints receipts.

Menu

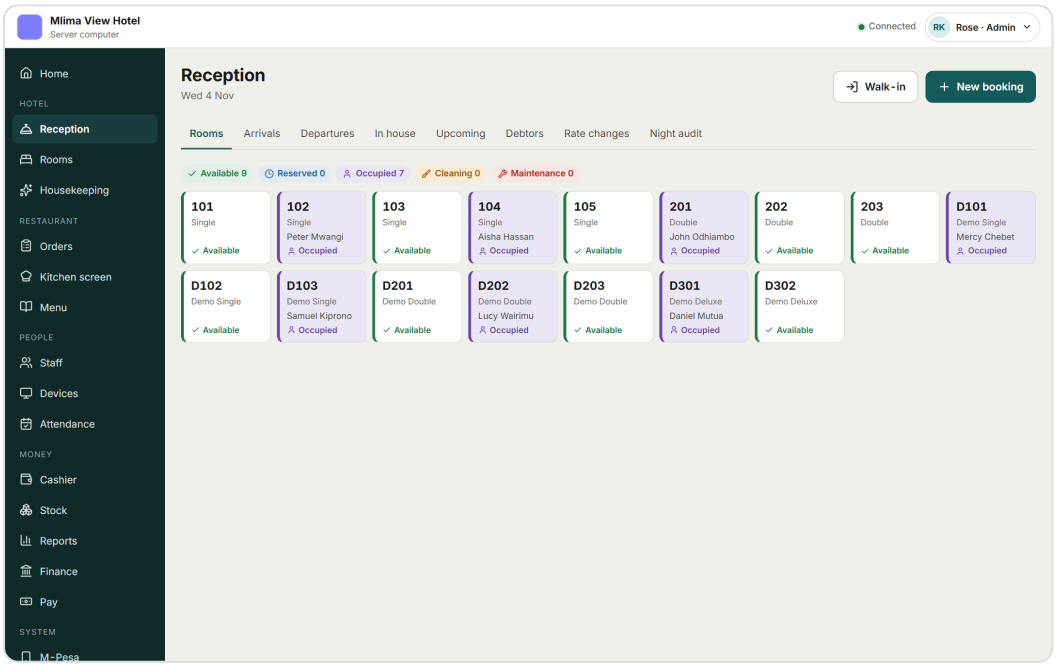
Menu: add categories (each one prints at a station), items with prices, and tables.

Staff

Staff → Add staff member: name, username and role (receptionist, waiter, cashier, kitchen, housekeeping, storekeeper, finance, manager). Each person gets a temporary PIN and chooses their own at first sign-in.

Tablets and phones

1. On the tablet, connect to the hotel Wi-Fi and scan the QR code on the server's setup page (or type the address shown under **Network**).
2. Install the hotel's security certificate when asked. The setup page shows how on Android and on Windows.
3. The tablet shows a 6-digit code. A manager approves it under **Devices**.
4. On tablets, use **Add to home screen** so RG HotelOS opens like an app.
5. Mark the reception tablet as a **clock-in point** so staff clock in there.



Reception: the room grid shows every room's status.

7 M-Pesa for guest payments

To send M-Pesa prompts to guests' phones, the hotel needs its own Safaricom Daraja app (the hotel's paybill or till).

1. Open **M-Pesa** (admin only) and choose paybill or till.
2. Enter the shortcode, consumer key, consumer secret and passkey from Safaricom.
3. Press **Test**: a KES 1 prompt confirms everything works.

A payment counts as paid only when Safaricom confirms it. M-Pesa codes that staff type in by hand stay "unverified" until finance checks them against the statement.

8 Everyday running

- **Night audit at 23:59:** puts each occupied room's night on the guest's bill and prints the day close (Z) report.
- **Backups:** every 15 minutes on the server, plus daily to USB and Google Drive.
- **Updates:** download and install themselves only in the quiet hours (02:00 to 05:00 by default, under Backups and updates) once nobody has been working for 30 minutes. If a new version does not start properly, the previous one and its data are put back automatically.
- **Admin home screen:** today's revenue, cash vs M-Pesa, occupancy, orders, and alerts (printer down, backup problem, clock changed, update ready, licence). Press **Seen** once an alert is dealt with.
- **Money rules:** nothing financial is deleted or edited. Mistakes are reversed with a reason, and the audit log records who did what. Discounts beyond a limit, refunds and guests leaving with a balance need a manager's PIN.
- **Reports:** choose a report and a period, then **Excel** or **Print / PDF**.

9 If the server breaks or is stolen

1. Get a new PC and install RG HotelOS (section 3).
2. On the first screen choose **Restore a backup instead**.
3. Plug in the USB backup drive, or download the latest file from the hotel's Google Drive "RG HotelOS backups" folder.
4. Type the recovery key from the Backup Recovery Sheet, then restart.
5. Contact RG Devs to move the licence to the new PC (free of charge), then pair the tablets again.

10 Hand-over checklist

Go through this with the owner before you leave the hotel.

- [ ] The server starts by itself after a power cut (BIOS set; tested by switching off at the wall).
- [ ] The licence is active (trial, key or plan) and the owner knows how to renew in the app.
- [ ] The admin recovery key and the Backup Recovery Sheet are with the owner, not at the server.
- [ ] The USB backup drive is marked and has a copy. Google Drive is connected (optional).
- [ ] A test order printed at the kitchen and the bar. A test receipt printed.
- [ ] A test M-Pesa prompt (KES 1) arrived and was confirmed.
- [ ] Every tablet and phone is paired and reaches the server from every floor.
- [ ] Each staff member has their own account and has changed their PIN.
- [ ] The owner knows the alerts on the admin home screen and where the reports are.
- [ ] A notice at reception tells guests why ID is collected (Data Protection Act).

Installed by (RG Devs) · Date

Received by (hotel) · Date

11 Support and licence plans

RG Devs support
Email: rgdev.ke@gmail.com
WhatsApp: +254 140 205 383
The Licence screen's Email and WhatsApp buttons send your hotel name and machine code for you.

Plan	KES
Free trial (14 days)	0
1 week	150
1 month	1,000
12 months	10,000
Lifetime	30,000

One licence covers one hotel server and unlimited staff and devices. Terms and conditions and the privacy policy are on the RG HotelOS website. © 2026 RG Devs, Kenya.